Repeated Cheap Talk with Disclose Signal History

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Abstract

Inspired by *Credible Persuasion* (Lin and Liu (2024)), I study how the sender creates credibility by constraining the frequency of signals in a sequential game. I consider a repeated cheap talk game with disclosed history, where the sender cannot commit to a signal strategy and the receiver is myopic. I show that, even when an informative Bayesian persuasion outcome cannot be sustained in a one-shot cheap talk equilibrium, the sender can sustain an informative equilibrium by committing to a restricted set of signal histories, provided that the sender's payoff is supermodular. I further show that an informative equilibrium exists if a strategy induces a set of histories with a bounded frequency of signals recommending actions preferred by the sender in some states. This restriction of message histories is equivalent to establishing a form of self-punishment that is observable through the message history, where the punishment increases the sender's own cost of sending a preferred signal. The sender loses credibility if he fails to enforce this punishment when the condition is met. I illustrate the strategy using an investment advice game.

Keywords: Cheap talk, dynamic persuasion, credibility, repeated games

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